FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BALL, GAUZE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers a gauze ball with radiopaque insert, suitable for use as a surgical sponge.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 **Specifications and standards.**—The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

UU-T-116 — Tape, Paper, Gummed, Water-Resistant.

CCC-G-101—Gauze, Absorbent.

PPP-B-636—Boxes, Fiber.

PPP-T-0045 — Tape, Gummed, Paper, Reinforced.

PPP-T-76 — Tape, Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive, Paper, Water Resistant.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging and Packing Levels.

Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipments (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-129 — Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 *Gauze.*—Gauze shall be type III, class 1, in accordance with the requirements of Federal Specification CCC-G-101.

3.1.2 *Radiopaque insert.* — The X-ray opaque insert shall be in the form of a monofilament. The monofilament shall be fabricated of either textile or plastic material, and shall be impregnated with an inert, nontoxic substance which is opaque to X-rays. The insert

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shall appear prominent and conspicuous when covered by at least 5/8 inch of aluminum when tested as specified in 4.4.2. The insert shall not bleed, become tacky, or show any other signs of deterioration when tested as specified in 4.4.3.

3.2 Dimensions.

3.2.1 *Gauze.*—The cut size of the gauze, before forming ball, shall be 12 by 12 inches ± ½-inch tolerance for both dimensions.

3.2.2 *Radiopaque insert.* — The monofilament shall be 10 inches ± 2 inches long.

3.2.3 *Finished ball.*—The finished size of the ball shall be 1½ inches ± ¼ inch in diameter.

3.3 Construction.—Gauze shall be 1-ply and shall have a radiopaque insert placed and secured between the plies as the ball is formed. Ball shall be formed with lip for forceps. The finished product shall have no exposed raw edges.

3.4 Workmanship.—Workmanship shall be first class throughout. The gauze ball, with radiopaque insert, shall be free from defects which detract from the appearance or which may impair its serviceability.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Supplier responsibilities for inspection. —Unless otherwise specified herein, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements prior to submission for Government inspection and acceptance. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examinations and tests shall be kept complete and available to the Government as specified in the contract or order.

4.1.1 Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual, auditory, etc., investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.2 *Certificates of quality.*—When available, certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the component or material, listing the specified test method and test results obtained, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 *For examination.*—Sampling for the examination shall be conducted in accordance with instructions furnished by the procuring activity.

4.2.2 *For tests.*—Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–105.

Component	Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Unit of product	Inspection level	AQL
Ball	gauze	3.1.1	4.4.1	ball	L2	0
Insert	radiopaqueness	3.1.2	4.4.2	ball or insert	L4	0
Insert	bleeding	3.1.2	4.4.3	ball or insert	L6	1.0

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4.2.3 *Components.*—Sufficient samples of the components shall be selected from each lot of material used in the manufacture of the gauze balls to perform tests as required by the applicable subsidiary specifications or by tests specified herein. When sample size for components covered by the subsidiary specifications is not specified, the sample size for each test shall be as indicated above. No test result shall fall below the minimum or exceed the maximum values specified. The sample unit for testing shall be the quantity necessary to perform all required tests one time each. Not less than 3 samples shall be taken regardless of lot size. Lot sizes are expressed as follows:

Gauze _____yards
Insert _____yards

4.2.4 Where possible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

4.3 Examination.—The gauze balls shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification.

4.4 Tests.—Tests shall be conducted, as necessary, to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 *Gauze.*—Gauze shall be tested in accordance with Federal Specification CCC–G–101.

4.4.2 *Radiopaque insert (opacity).*—In testing for opacity, the insert shall be placed on an unexposed X-ray plate and covered with an aluminum ladder ranging in thickness from at least ⅛ to ¾ inch in steps of ⅛ inch, using an exposure such that the steps of at least ¼-inch, ⅜-inch, ½-inch, and ⅝-inch are clearly delineated from each other.

4.4.3 *Radiopaque insert (bleeding).*—In testing for bleeding, tackiness, or other signs of deterioration, the insert shall be sterilized by live steam at a temperature of 250° F. for one hour.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(For civil agency procurement Federal Standard No. 102 shall be referred to for definitions and applications of the various levels of packaging and packing protection for supplies and equipment.)

5.1 Packaging.

5.1.1 *Unit of issue.*—One hundred balls, as specified, constitute one unit.

5.1.2 *Packaging quantities.*—The number of units of issue indicated in table I shall be packaged in each unit, intermediate, and exterior container, as applicable, for the required level of protection specified in procurement document.

TABLE I.—*Packaging quantities*

Unit package	Intermediate package	Exterior container
1 unit _____	20 units	40 units

5.1.2.1 *Packing variation permitted.*—If the required number of units to be shipped is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units shall be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which will insure safe delivery to destination.

5.1.3 *Level A.*

5.1.3.1 *Unit package.*—Each unit shall be packaged in a bag fabricated from polyethylene seamless tubing having an average wall thickness of not less than 0.004-inch, with no wall thickness at any point below 0.00325-inch. Excess air shall be expelled or evacuated, and closure effected by heat-sealing.

5.1.3.2 *Intermediate package.*—Intermediate package shall be a carton of appropriate size constructed in accordance with Federal

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Specification PPP-B-636, class 2, compliance symbol W5c or W5s, style RSC, except that the manufacturer's joint shall be effected either by sealing as specified in 3.3.3.3 of Federal Specification PPP-B-636, or by means of metal stitches. When metal stitches are used, they shall be covered by means of a suitable tape applied over the stitches on the interior surface of the box.

5.1.3.2.1 *Closure.*—Closure shall be effected by means of tape conforming to the requirements of Federal Specification UU-T-116, PPP-T-0045, or PPP-T-76. The tape shall be not less than 2 inches wide, and shall be applied to both top and bottom so that the center seams are covered their full length. Tape shall extend at least 2 inches onto each of the end panels. Tape will not be required on manufacturer's joint.

5.1.4 *Level C.*—Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose within the continental limits of the United States of America.

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 *Level A.*

5.2.1.1 *Exterior container.*—Exterior container shall be a box of appropriate size constructed in accordance with Federal Specification PPP-B-636, class 2, compliance symbol V3c or V3s, style RSC.

5.2.1.1.1 *Closure.*—Closure shall be as specified in 30.2.2.1 of Federal Specification PPP-B-636, and in addition, the top and bottom center seams shall be closed by means of tape conforming to the requirements of Federal Specification UU-T-116, PPP-T-0045, or PPP-T-76. The tape shall be not less than 2 inches wide and shall extend at least 2 inches onto each of the end panels. Strapping will not be required.

5.2.2 *Level B.*—Material packaged as specified in 5.1.3 shall be packed in boxes conforming to Federal Specification PPP-B-636 (type I, class 1, style RSC, for type 2 load).

5.2.3 *Level C.*—Material packaged as specified in 5.1.4 shall be packed according to the supplier's commercial domestic practice to assure acceptance by the carrier and safe delivery to destination at the lowest transportation rate or rating. Containers shall comply with carrier rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation without assessment of penalty charges for improper packing.

5.2.4 *Level D.*—Material packaged as specified in 5.1.4 shall be packed according to the supplier's commercial export practice to assure acceptance by the carrier and safe delivery to destination at the lowest transportation rate or rating. Containers shall comply with carrier rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation without assessment of penalty charges for improper packing.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 *For civil agencies.*—In addition to marking required in the contract or purchase order, shipments shall be marked in accordance with Federal Standard No. 123.

5.3.2 *For military agencies.*

5.3.2.1 *Interior packages.*—Each unit package and intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with section 5 of Military Standard MIL-STD-129. The information required on unit package shall be printed directly on the bag, or on a label inserted within the bag in such manner as to permit ready identification.

5.3.2.2 *Exterior container.*—Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL-STD-129, except that 6.2(c), 6.2(d), 6.5, and 7.5.1 shall not

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be applicable. Service color and service symbol markings are required only on direct shipments from the contractor's plant to overseas activities.

6. NOTES

6.1 **Ordering data.**—Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title number, and date of this specification.

(*b*) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing, and marking (see 5.1, 5.2, and 5.3).

6.2 This specification does not include all types, classes, grades, sizes, etc., of the commodity indicated by the title of this specification, or which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the types, etc., which are normally procured to meet Federal Government requirements.

6.3 **Transportation description.**—Transportation description applicable to this item is:

Dressing, Surgeons'

Carload minimum weight 24,000 pounds subject to Rule 34 of the Uniform Freight Classification.

Truckload minimum weight 24,000 pounds per National Motor Freight Classification.

Notice. — When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTERESTS:
Army—M
Navy—Md
Air Force.

Copies of this specification may be purchased for 5 cents each.

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